

laden music that harked back to late Romanticism. Born into a wealthy Viennese family, he had a difficult adolescence, failing at school and also fathering an illegitimate child by a housemaid. He began composing songs at the age of 15 but completely lacked any formal training whatsoever until Schoenberg took him on as one of his pupils in 1904. One of Berg's first major works was the *Altenberg Lieder*, which premiered at the "Scandal Concert" in Vienna in 1913. After serving in the Austro-Hungarian Army in World War I, he completed the Expressionist opera *Wozzeck* in 1922. Performed by the Berlin State Opera in 1925, it earned the composer great notoriety. His music was denounced by the Nazi Party as being degenerate and was virtually banned following their rise to power in Germany in 1933. Berg's last completed work, the celebrated *Violin Concerto*, was written as an elegy for Alma Mahler's daughter. Dying of septicemia, he left the opera *Lulu* unfinished.

KEY WORKS: *Altenberg Lieder* (soprano and orchestra), Op. 4, 1912; *Wozzeck* (opera), Op. 7, 1922; *Lyric Suite* (string quartet), 1926; *Violin Concerto*, 1935

Bohuslav Martinů
